Part 2

What do I want? Defining requirements using BDD

BDD principles are applicable at all levels of software development, from requirements discovery and definition right through to low-level coding and regression testing. Part 2 of this book focuses on the first aspect of BDD: how BDD is used to discover and describe the features you need to build. Part 2 is written for the whole team.

In chapter 3, we'll take a step back. You'll see how important it is to consider and understand the business motivation and value behind the software you're asked to deliver. You'll learn how to discuss the relative value of proposed features and use these discussions to determine what features to build, and, more importantly, what features not to build. This is at the heart of *building the right software.*

In chapter 4, we'll go into more detail. You'll learn how BDD teams collaborate to discover, describe, and define the features they need to deliver. You'll discover how to explore the scope and detailed requirements of a feature using conversation and concrete examples, and how these conversations can change your understanding of the features you're trying to define.

In chapter 5, you'll learn how to formalize the examples we discussed in chapter 4 in a clear, unambiguous form that we'll refer to as *executable specifications.* This too is a collaborative process; as you'll see, the act of expressing the